'Barry Loser' Books Are Becoming a Cartoon

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Barry Loser is a 10-year-old boy with a giant **imagination**. He is the star of the funny "Barry Loser" books by Jim Smith. Now the books are being turned into a **cartoon**!

The books have won a prize for funny writing, the Roald Dahl Funny Prize. They have sold more than a million copies and been **translated** into 17 languages. In the stories, Barry makes a trip to the store or a visit to grandma's feel like a huge adventure.

Two companies, one from the U.K. and one from Italy, are making the show. It will have 52 **episodes**, and each one will be 11 minutes long. It will look **hand-drawn**, like the books.

Mark Procter, who leads one of the companies, said the books were his son's favorite. They read them every night.

The team is still raising money. They hope to start making the show in 2027.

Word Treasure

imagination -- Imagination is the ability to picture new and exciting ideas in your mind.

cartoon -- A cartoon is a show made with moving drawings.

translated -- Translated means changed from one language into another.

episodes -- Episodes are the separate parts of a TV show.

hand-drawn -- Hand-drawn means drawn by a person's hand instead of only by a computer.

Background you need

Many favorite children's books get turned into TV shows or movies.

A cartoon is made from many drawings shown quickly so they look like they move.

Making a TV show costs a lot of money, so companies often work together.

Break it down

WHO: Author Jim Smith's character Barry Loser and two TV companies from the U.K. and Italy
WHAT: The funny Barry Loser books are being turned into a cartoon
WHERE: Made by companies in the U.K. and Italy, about a boy in an ordinary town
WHY: The books are loved by kids, including the son of one company's leader

Why it matters

Kids who love the books may soon get to watch Barry's funny adventures on TV.

Test what you remember

1. Who is Barry Loser?

(A) A famous singer
(B) A 10-year-old boy with a giant imagination
(C) A dog
(D) A real football player

2. Who wrote the Barry Loser books?

(A) Jim Smith
(B) Roald Dahl
(C) Flea
(D) Mark Procter

3. How many copies have the books sold?

(A) More than a million
(B) Exactly 52
(C) About 17
(D) About 100

4. How long will each episode be?

(A) Two minutes
(B) Three hours
(C) One hour
(D) 11 minutes

5. Which countries are the two companies from?

(A) Japan and Canada
(B) The U.S. and Mexico
(C) The U.K. and Italy
(D) France and Spain

6. When do they hope to start making the show?

(A) 2030
(B) Next week
(C) 2027
(D) They already finished

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: A 4: D 5: C 6: C

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):